

WEEKLY CA – 23rd May – 29th May

1. The theme for Commonwealth Day 2026 is:

राष्ट्रमंडल दिवस 2026 का विषय है:

- A. One Future, Shared Prosperity
- B. Empowering Global Partnerships
- C. Unlocking opportunities together for a prosperous Commonwealth
- D. Commonwealth for Sustainable Growth

Answer: C.

24th May - Commonwealth Day in India

- Commonwealth Day (formerly Empire Day) is **commemorated on second Monday of March.**
- **India and a few other countries celebrate it on 24th May.**
- The day honoured the British Empire and Queen Victoria's birthday - She was born on May 24, 1819.
- Commonwealth Day **honours unity among 56 nations** committed to peace, democracy, and development.
- **The 2026 theme, "Unlocking opportunities together for a prosperous Commonwealth"**



Date	Day	Theme
23 rd May	World Turtle Day	
23 rd May	International Day to End Obstetric Fistula	Her Health Is a Right: Invest to End Fistula and Childbirth Injuries
24 th May	Commonwealth Day in India	Unlocking opportunities together for a prosperous Commonwealth
25 th May	Africa Day	Sixty-three (63) Years of Unity, Integration and Development, let's celebrate together
25 th May	World Thyroid Day	Thyroid and Nutrition
25 th – 31 st May	International Week of Solidarity with the Peoples of Non-Self-Governing Territories	
25 th May	World Football Day	
28 th May	Menstrual Hygiene Day	
28 th May	World Dugong Day	A decade beneath the waves: Dugongs & Us
28 th May	World Hunger Day	A World Without Hunger is in Our Hands
29 th May	International Everest Day	
29 th May	International Day of UN Peacekeepers	Invest in Peace

2. CLEAR technology was developed for:

CLEAR तकनीक का विकास इसके लिए किया गया था:

- (a) Genome editing in plants
- (b) Satellite navigation systems
- (c) Quantum communication research
- (d) High-resolution multiplex protein imaging

Answer: (D)

CLEAR Technology

- Researchers in India have developed a **groundbreaking protein imaging platform called CLEAR, which allows multiple proteins to be mapped within a single biological sample using a single fluorescent marker.**
- A novel, highly multiplexed spatial protein imaging platform that allows a vast number of proteins to be visualized and mapped within the same cells or tissue sections.
- **Full Form:** Cleavable Light-Erased Antibody Reporter (CLEAR).

- **Developed By:** The Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research (JNCASR), an autonomous institute under the Ministry of Science and Technology.

Aim:

- The primary **aim of CLEAR technology is to overcome the structural limits of conventional imaging, which struggle to map multiple proteins simultaneously within a single specimen** while preserving their spatial organization.
- It aims to provide high-resolution, high-plex protein maps **to decode complex cellular behavior in diseases like cancer and neurological disorders.**

3. "Love, Anatomy and Coconut Chutney" was authored by:

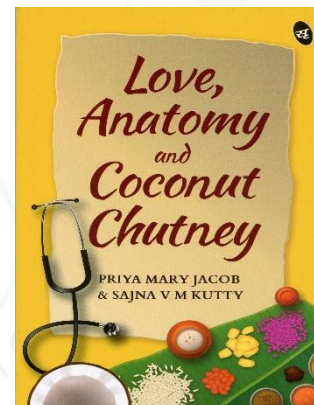
"Love, Anatomy and Coconut Chutney" के लेखक थे:

- (a) Sudha Murty and Shashi Tharoor
- (b) Dr Priya Mary Jacob and Dr Sajna VM Kutty
- (c) Arundhati Roy and Kiran Desai
- (d) Anita Nair and Chetan Bhagat

Answer: (b)

English novel 'Love, Anatomy and Coconut Chutney' is a fictional take on some real-life campus stories by two doctors

- English novel Love, Anatomy and Coconut Chutney
- **Authors** : Dr Priya Mary Jacob and Dr Sajna VM Kutty.

**4. Who has been appointed as the new chairman of the Rajya Sabha Committee on Petitions?**

राज्यसभा की याचिका समिति के नए अध्यक्ष के रूप में किसे नियुक्त किया गया है?

- A. C.P. Radhakrishnan
- B. Jagdeep Dhankhar
- C. Raghav Chadha
- D. Piyush Goyal

Answer: C

Raghav Chadha appointed chairman of Rajya Sabha Committee on Petitions

- Rajya Sabha MP Raghav Chadha, who switched from the AAP to the BJP recently, has been appointed as the new chairman of the Committee on Petitions of the Upper House.
- **After reconstituting the Committee on Petitions, Rajya Sabha chairman C.P. Radhakrishnan nominated 10 members of the house to the panel**

What is a Parliamentary Committee?

- A Parliamentary committee is a committee of Members of Parliament (MPs) who are elected or appointed from amongst the members of the house or nominated by the Speaker or Chairman. **The concept of Parliamentary committees originated in the British Parliament.**
- These committees operate under the direction of the Speaker of Lok Sabha or Chairman of Rajya Sabha and present their findings and recommendations to the respective houses.
- **The Parliamentary committees draw their authority from the constitution.**
- **Article 105:** Powers, privileges, etc., of the houses of Parliament and of the members and committees thereof.
- **Article 118:** Each House of Parliament may make rules for regulations, subject to the provisions of this constitution, its procedure and the conduct of its business.

**5. Raja Randhir Singh, who recently passed away, became India's first Asian Games gold medallist in:**

राजा रणधीर सिंह, जिनका हाल ही में निधन हो गया, भारत के पहले एशियाई खेलों के स्वर्ण पदक विजेता बने:

- (a) Athletics

- (b) Shooting
- (c) Boxing
- (d) Wrestling

Answer: (b)

Five-time Olympian shooter Raja Randhir Singh passes away

- Raja Randhir Singh, the veteran sports administrator, a former five-time Olympian, and most importantly, **India's first Asian Games gold medalist in shooting, has passed away**
- Randhir Singh **created history in the 1978 Asian Games in Bangkok by becoming the first Indian to win a gold medal in the shooting discipline (trap event); he also represented India at five Olympic Games**
- Randhir Singh also **received the coveted Arjuna Award** for his contribution.
- From **serving as the Secretary General of the Indian Olympic Association and later a member of the International Olympic Committee.**



6. Lance Havildar Harbhajan Singh and Naib Subedar Sujit Kumar Pradhan, recently seen in news, will be posthumously honoured by the United Nations with which of the following awards?

लांस हवलदार हरभजन सिंह और नायब सूबेदार सुजीत कुमार प्रधान, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहे, को संयुक्त राष्ट्र द्वारा मरणोपरांत निम्नलिखित में से किस पुरस्कार से सम्मानित किया जाएगा?

- (a) Dag Hammarskjöld Medal
- (b) Nobel Peace Prize
- (c) UN Peacekeeping Service Medal
- (d) Blue Helmet Award

Answer: (a)

Two Indian peacekeepers to be honoured posthumously on International Peacekeepers Day

- **Lance Havildar Harbhajan Singh, who served with the United Nations Organisation Stabilisation Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO), and Naib Subedar Sujit Kumar Pradhan, who was deployed with the UN Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS), will be posthumously honoured by the United Nations for their ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty on the International Day of UN Peacekeepers.**
- **The medal is named after Dag Hammarskjöld, the second Secretary-General of the United Nations, who died in 1961 in a plane crash in present-day Zambia**
- Additionally, UN Secretary General Antonio Guterres will present the 2025 Military Gender Advocate of the Year award to Major Abhilasha Barak of India, who serves on the UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL), honouring her outreach efforts with women and girls during her deployment in the West Asian nation.
- **India is the second largest contributor of uniformed personnel to UN Peacekeeping.** It currently contributes more than 4,200 military and police personnel, including 155 women, to UN peace operations.



7. Which Indian city is set to host the World Indoor Championships 2028?

भारत का कौन सा शहर वर्ल्ड इंडोर चैंपियनशिप 2028 की मेज़बानी करने के लिए तैयार है?

- (a) Chandigarh
- (b) Mumbai
- (c) Bhubaneswar
- (d) Kochi

Answer: (c)

India to host 2027 Asian Relays and 2028 Asian Indoor Championships

- The bids were approved by the Asian Athletics Association (AAA) during its executive council meeting in Hong Kong China.
- **Chandigarh will be the host city for the third edition of the Asian Relay Championships.**



- Meanwhile, **Bhubaneswar will host the Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028 at the Kalinga Stadium.**
 - The same venue is also set to stage the World Indoor Championships 2028 from March 3 to 5.

8. PM-AJAY scheme is implemented by which ministry?

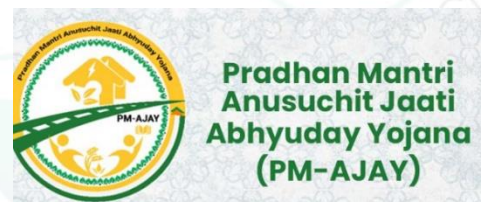
PM-AJAY योजना किस मंत्रालय द्वारा कार्यान्वित की जाती है?

- (a) Ministry of Rural Development
- (b) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- (c) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- (d) Ministry of Tribal Affairs

Answer: (c)

The Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyuday Yojna (PM-AJAY)

- **The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** launched the centralized PM-AJAY Portal and the AJAY Mobile Application.
- PM AJAY (Pradhan Mantri Anusuchit Jaati Abhyuday Yojana) scheme is a comprehensive initiative launched in FY 2021-22.
- It is **aimed at the socio-economic upliftment of Scheduled Castes (SCs).**
- It is a **merger scheme of three erstwhile Centrally Sponsored Schemes**, namely, Pradhan Mantri Adarsh Gram Yojana (PMAGY), Special Central Assistance to Scheduled Castes Sub Plan (SCA to SCSP) and Babu Jagjivan Ram Chhatrawas Yojana (BJRCY).
- It **focuses on reducing poverty, enhancing educational opportunities**, and improving infrastructure in SC-dominated areas.
- Nodal Ministry: Implemented by the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment.



Eligibility Criteria for the Scheme

- The Scheduled Castes persons living below the poverty lines are eligible for getting benefits under the various Income Generating Schemes and Skill Development Programmes.
- **In case of Infrastructure Development, the villages having 50% or more SC population are eligible for grants under the Scheme.**

Key Components of the Scheme

- **Transforming SC-majority villages into 'Adarsh Grams'** (model villages) by filling critical gaps in infrastructure and services.
- **Providing financial assistance for district/state-level projects aimed at the socio-economic betterment of SCs.**

This includes:

- Creation of infrastructure in SC-dominated villages
- Construction of hostels/residential schools
- **Comprehensive livelihood projects, including skill development and related infrastructure.**
- Financial assistance towards loans taken by beneficiaries for asset acquisition/creation required for livelihood generation.
- **Construction of Hostels:** It includes building hostels in higher educational institutions ranked under the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) and funded by the Centre/State/UT Governments, schools funded by the Centre/State/UT Governments and recommended by the Ministry of Education

9. The proposed "Delhi Declaration" is related to:

प्रस्तावित "दिल्ली घोषणा" किससे संबंधित है?

- A. Climate finance reforms
- B. Global big cat conservation
- C. Maritime security cooperation
- D. Nuclear disarmament

Answer: B.

Big Cat Summit in New Delhi postponed

- India has postponed the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) summit that was scheduled in New Delhi on June 1.
- Delhi Declaration:** The first global declaration on big cat conservation, aimed at promoting shared priorities, transboundary cooperation, and a landscape-based approach for protecting big cats and their habitats.
- The summit was expected to have significant representation from African countries.
- The First IBCA Summit was scheduled in conjunction with the Fourth India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS IV), as several African countries host big cats and are important partners in global efforts towards conservation, ecological sustainability and biodiversity protection.

**India-Africa Forum Summit**

- It is the highest apex institutional platform for dialogue and cooperation between India and African countries.
- It was established in 2008.
- Purpose:** It aims to strengthen political dialogue, economic cooperation, trade, investment, technology transfer, capacity building and people-to-people relations between India and Africa

10. India's first National AI and Digital Water Summit, "National AI Summit on Water 2026", will be hosted in:

भारत का पहला राष्ट्रीय AI और डिजिटल जल शिखर सम्मेलन, "National AI Summit on Water 2026", यहाँ आयोजित किया जाएगा:

- Bengaluru
- Chennai
- Hyderabad
- Pune

Answer: (a)

**BWSSB to host India's first National AI and Digital Water Summit**

- India's first National AI and Digital Water Summit, titled the National AI Summit on Water 2026, will be hosted by the Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board (BWSSB) in Bengaluru on 27 May 2026.
- The summit is jointly organised by BWSSB and EleTs Technomedia Pvt. Ltd..
- The summit will focus on AI-enabled smart operations, digital twins, water-loss management, energy optimisation, data governance, ethical AI, and cybersecurity.
- The summit will also present BWSSB's Five Panchasutras framework for future urban water governance.
- The framework includes artificial intelligence, data-driven governance, smart infrastructure, sustainable investments, and climate-resilient water security systems.
- BWSSB plans to launch an integrated AI-powered command centre for water and sewage management at Shimsha Bhavan in Jayanagar.

11. The term "memflation" is associated with:

"Memflation" शब्द किससे संबंधित है?

- Inflation in renewable energy markets
- Rising prices of semiconductor memory components
- Decline in global stock market valuations
- Increasing costs of agricultural commodities

Answer: (b)

Memflation

- Global semiconductor revenues are projected to surpass the unprecedented \$1.3 trillion threshold this year, marking a staggering 64% increase compared to 2025.

- A primary driver of this surge is a phenomenon dubbed **memflation**, which is triggering massive price hikes for memory chips and disrupting non-AI technology supply chains well into 2028.
- **Memflation** is a term coined by Gartner analysts to describe the rapid, structural price inflation sweeping the semiconductor market, specifically targeting data storage and memory components.
- It represents a **significant market distortion where the hyper-growth of AI infrastructure consumes the lion's share of semiconductor fabrication resources**, triggering severe shortages and soaring costs for traditional computing hardware.

Primary Causes of Memflation:

- **Rapid spending by hyperscalers and cloud firms on AI infrastructure** has diverted memory resources away from traditional computing markets.
- Companies like Micron Technology are prioritizing high-margin AI GPUs and enterprise memory over consumer components.
- **Fear of tariffs and price hikes** pushed firms to stockpile chips in 2025–26, sharply reducing available inventories.

Impacts of Memflation:

- Rising memory costs are slowing **enterprise IT upgrades and delaying deployment of conventional digital infrastructure**.
- Semiconductor shortages and logistics bottlenecks have caused widespread shipment delays across global hardware markets.
- **Laptop, server, and enterprise hardware makers are passing Analysts caution CIOs against locking into expensive multi-year semiconductor supply agreements amid volatile pricing trends.**

12. Consider the following pairs regarding the 79th Cannes Film Festival awards:

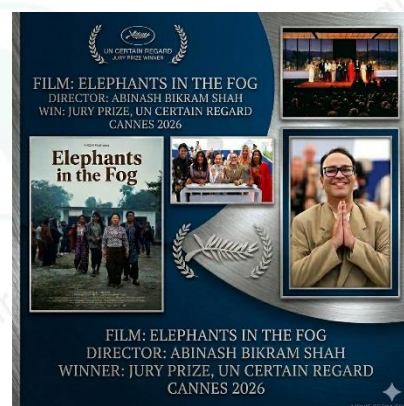
1. Minotaure — Grand Prix Award
2. The Dreamed Adventure — Jury Prize
3. For The Opponents — Short Film Palme d'Or

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Cannes 2026: Nepal's 'Elephants in the Fog' creates history, wins Un Certain Regard Jury Prize



- The 79th edition of the Cannes Film Festival concluded on May 23, at the Grand Theatre Lumiere, awarding the best from the 22 films.
- **The Palme d'Or went to Cristian Mungiu's drama Fjord, starring Sebastian Stan and Renate Reinsve, marking the Romanian director's second Palme d'Or in 19 years.**
- In 2007, he won the coveted prize for 4 Months, 3 Weeks and 2 Days.
- **Minotaure** — Grand Prix Russian director and screenwriter Andrey Zvyagintsev received the Grand Prix Award for Minotaure. The award was presented by Zoe Saldaña during the ceremony.
- Directorial duo Javier Calvo and Javier Ambrossi and Paweł Pawlikowski jointly took home the **Best Director Prize for La Bola Negra and Fatherland, respectively.**
- German director Valeska Grisebach's The Dreamed Adventure won the **Jury Prize.**
- In the festival's other award sections, Sandra Wollner's Everytime won the Un Certain Regard prize, and **the Nepali feature film Elephants in the Fog, written and directed by debut filmmaker Abinash Bikram Shah, scooped the Un Certain Regard Jury Prize.**
- Marine Atlan's La Gradiava bagged the Grand Prize in Critics' Week, and Clio Barnard's I See Buildings Fall Like Lightning took home the audience award in Directors' Fortnight.
- **Palme d'Or** - Fjord, Cristian Mungiu
- **Grand Prize** - Minotaur, Andrei Zviaguintsev
- **Best Actress** - Virginie Efira and Tao Okamo for All Of A Sudden

- **Best Director (tie)** - Javier Calvo and Javier Ambrossi, La Bola Negra
Paweł Pawlikowski, Fatherland
- **Jury Prize** - The Dreamed Adventure, Valeska Grisebach
- **Best Screenplay** - Emmanuel Marre for A Man Of His Time (Notre Salut)
- **Best Actor** - Emmanuel Macchia, Valentin Campagneshare for Coward
- **Other awards** - Camera d'Or
Ben'Imana, Clémentine Dusabejambo
- **Short Film Palme d'Or** - For The Opponents, Federico Luis.

13. Consider the following statements regarding the SARTHAK-PDS Scheme:

1. It is implemented under the National Food Security Act, 2013.
2. The scheme will be implemented for five years beginning April 1, 2026.
3. It abolishes e-PoS-enabled fair price shops.

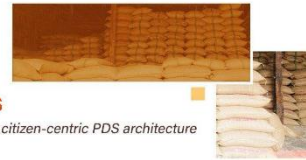
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Cabinet approves extension of SARTHAK-PDS scheme with central outlay of ₹25,530 crore

- The Union Cabinet approved **extension of the 'SARTHAK-PDS' scheme, with an outlay of ₹25,530 crore, to provide assistance to State agencies for intra-State movement of food grains and modernisation of public distribution system.**
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved the continuation of the **'Scheme for Assistance in Ration Transport and Handling-Income with Automation in PDS' (SARTHAK-PDS)** as an umbrella scheme for the next five years, in the 16th Finance Commission cycle award period.
- The **scheme will be implemented for a five-year duration, beginning April 1, 2026,**
- The scheme, in the 16th Finance Commission cycle award period, integrates the ongoing schemes of 'Assistance to State Agencies for intra-State movement of foodgrains and FPS dealers' margin under NFSA.
- **SARTHAK-PDS Scheme seeks to modernize, integrate and intelligently optimize PDS operations through advanced technologies** such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML), Natural Language Processing (NLP) and Blockchain.
- The digital platform of Sarthak-PDS will **streamline national food security operations.**
- The **scheme also proposes state-level command and control centres and unified databases for PDS operations.**



SARTHAK-PDS

Building a unified and citizen-centric PDS architecture

- ▶ Merged scheme to operate till **31.03.2031**
- ▶ **Assured financial support** for intra-State movement, handling and FPS dealers' margin
- ▶ Scheme to support **food security for 81.35 crore NFSA beneficiaries**
- ▶ Unified and interoperable PDS architecture to strengthen NFSA implementation
- ▶ AI, ML, NLP and Blockchain to modernise PDS operations
- ▶ Real-time monitoring and AI-driven grievance systems to be developed
- ▶ Aachhar seeding, e-PoS automation and computerised supply-chain management to be expanded across States/UTs

2/2

CABINET DECISION: 27-06-2025

14. The chairperson of the high-level committee constituted to examine unnatural demographic changes across India is:

पूरे भारत में अप्राकृतिक जनसांख्यिकीय परिवर्तनों की जाँच के लिए गठित उच्च-स्तरीय समिति के अध्यक्ष हैं:

- (a) Justice D. Y. Chandrachud
(b) Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar
(c) Justice N. V. Ramana
(d) Justice U. U. Lalit

Answer: (b)

The Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar Committee

- **Union Home Minister announced the constitution of a high-level committee to address the complex challenges arising from unnatural demographic changes across India due to long-term illegal immigration and infiltration.**



- ### Core Committee Members:

- ### Key Features:

-

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF STATISTICS AND
PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION

MINISTRY OF STATISTICS AND PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION

MoSPI, through the PAMANA portal, aims to strengthen monitoring of infrastructure projects, and sectoral performance through technology-enabled platforms, and evidence-based assessment mechanisms.

Monitoring of Central Sector Infrastructure Projects Costing ₹150 Crore and Above

April, 2026

Key Highlights

9 [*] Projects reported completion	55 ^{**} New Projects onboarded worth ₹1.34 lakh crore
Key Projects Completed* • Flyover at Sakinaka, ₹46.54 crore Urban local to Nagpur-Hajur Road ₹1297 crore Ministry of Road Transport & Highways • Transmission system for evacuation of power from IEEE to Maharashtra 200MW under Phase III (Part 1) ₹688 crore Ministry of Power • Jabalpur Sewerage Management and Treatment Infrastructure Project ₹482 crore Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs	Key Projects Onboarded** • Bangalore Metro Rail Project - PHASE-3 ₹13,611 crore Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs • Kashi Hydel Electric Project (1200 MW) ₹14,103 crore Ministry of Power • Development of Zabeedah Nodur and Under Hyderabad Nagar Industrial Corridor ₹2,360 crore DPIIT

* Projects reported completion as of April 2026. ** Projects onboarded as of April 2026.

- PAIMANA (Project Assessment, Infrastructure Monitoring & Analytics for Nation-building) is a flagship initiative of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).
- It **functions as a centralised national repository of infrastructure projects, enabling web-generated analytical reports and enhancing data accuracy, and operational efficiency.**
- It is integrated with DPIIT's Integrated Project Monitoring Portal (IPMP/IIG-PMG) through APIs.

Key Features of the PAIMANA Portal

- It serves as a centralized project monitoring system, **providing a single-window interface for ministries, departments, and implementing agencies to upload, track, and review project information.**
- It features real-time dashboards with drill-down capabilities, enabling users to monitor progress across sectors, states, and timelines.
- It includes advanced data analytics, role-based user access, interactive dashboards, reporting and query modules, and review cases for identification of data gaps.
- It is **mandated to monitor Central Sector Infrastructure Projects worth ₹150 crore and above**

17. Haryana's first constellation garden has been developed at:

हरियाणा का पहला नक्षत्र वाटिका कहाँ विकसित किया गया है?

- A. Sultanpur National Park
- B. Kalesar National Park
- C. Bhindawas Wildlife Sanctuary
- D. Saraswati Wildlife Sanctuary

Answer: d

Saraswati Wildlife Sanctuary

- **Haryana's first constellation garden has been developed at the Saraswati Wildlife Sanctuary in the Seonsar forest area of Pehowa.**
- Saraswati Wildlife Sanctuary, also known as the Seonsar Forest, is located in the districts of Kaithal and Kurukshetra, in Haryana.
- **Culturally and ecologically significant, the sanctuary is tied to the mythical Saraswati River**, believed to have flowed through the region.
- **The sanctuary is also home to ancient archaeological remains, with bricks found here dating back to the Kushan and Gupta periods**, suggesting the area was inhabited over 1,500 years ago.
- There is also a **400-year-old Water well made of small lakhauri bricks associated with the Mughal empire era.**
- The forest is characterized by "tropical deciduous forest" vegetation, featuring dense clusters of Kikar, Neem, Shisham, and Peepal trees.
- It is a **critical habitat** for a variety of wildlife, including the Blue Bull (Nilgai), Wild Boar, Spotted Deer, and the rare Hog Deer.

18. The recently discovered "Loktak Protocluster" is related to:

हाल ही में खोजा गया "लोकतक प्रोटोक्लस्टर" किससे संबंधित है?

- (a) Marine biodiversity
- (b) Ancient civilization
- (c) Cosmic structure of young galaxies
- (d) Volcano research

Answer: (c)

Indian Scientist Discovers Loktak Protocluster

- A major international astronomy study led by an Indian scientist has **discovered a massive structure of young galaxies in the early universe, naming it after a famous lake in Manipur.**
- The cosmic structure has been officially named the Loktak Protocluster. It is a **primitive galaxy cluster, described by scientists as a "city of galaxies" that is still being built by the forces of gravity.**



- **The discovery was led by Dr Ronaldo Laishram, an astrophysicist from Manipur** who is currently a researcher at the National Astronomical Observatory of Japan (NAOJ).
- **Age:** The Loktak Protocluster is seen as it existed 12.6 billion years ago.
- The research team used data from the Subaru Telescope and the James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) to study this distant structure.

Why Loktak Lake?

- The decision to name the "city of galaxies" after Manipur's Loktak Lake bridges the gap between Earth's natural heritage and deep space.
- **Loktak Lake is famous for its floating islands of vegetation, known as phumdis, which exist within a single connected body of water.**
- Similarly, the **newly discovered cosmic structure contains four distinct concentrations of galaxies** that are interconnected as part of one massive, evolving system.

19. With reference to the BHAVYA (Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna) Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme.
2. It aims to develop investment-ready industrial parks across India.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

BHAVYA Scheme

- **Recently, the central government announced the launch of guidelines for the 'BHAVYA (Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna) Scheme'.**
- It is a Central Sector Scheme aimed at developing investment-ready, world-class industrial parks across the country.

The major focus of the Scheme is on creation of

- Investment-ready industrial ecosystems with plug-and-play infrastructure, multimodal logistics connectivity, reliable utility systems, worker-support infrastructure, digital governance systems, and sustainable development features.
- **Target:** It provides for development of 100 industrial parks.
- **Time Period:** Six years from 2026-27 to 2031-32.

Features of BHAVYA Scheme

- It has been designed to support the Centre's Make in India and PM Gati Shakti programmes by creating integrated, investment-ready manufacturing zones equipped with plug-and-play infrastructure and multimodal logistics connectivity.
- It **provides for development of both greenfield and eligible brownfield industrial parks.**
- **Minimum land requirements have been fixed at 100 acres for non-hilly states and 25 acres for hilly states, northeastern states, Union Territories, and smaller states.**
- **Implementation:** It will be undertaken through Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013



20. With respect to the Western Hoolock Gibbons, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A Sanctuary in North-east India is home to this ape species listed as Endangered in the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List.
2. They have specialized brachiation and can easily swing between trees.
3. They possess a strong and heavy build like gorillas, yet are remarkably agile tree climbers.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3

(d) 3 only

Answer: b

Hollongapar Gibbon Sanctuary

- **The first instance globally of a Western hoolock gibbon using an artificial canopy bridge over a railway line was recorded in Assam's Hollongapar Gibbon Sanctuary recently.**
- The Hollongapar Gibbon Sanctuary, previously called the Gibbon Wildlife Sanctuary or Hollongapar Reserve Forest, is an isolated evergreen forest in Jorhat district, Assam, India. It was renamed on May 25, 2004.
- **It is home to India's only gibbons, the hoolock gibbons, and Northeast India's only nocturnal primate, the Bengal slow loris.**
- The Hollongapar sanctuary got its first artificial canopy bridge in 2015.

Hoolock Gibbon

- **The forests of Northeast India are home to the country's only apes:** the western hoolock gibbon (Hoolock hoolock) and the eastern hoolock gibbon (Hoolock leuconedys).

The western hoolock gibbon is found in all the states of the northeast, restricted between the south of the Brahmaputra River and east of the Dibang River.

- It is also found in eastern Bangladesh and north-west Myanmar.
- It is listed as Endangered in the IUCN Red list and Schedule 1 of the Indian (Wildlife) Protection Act 1972.

The eastern hoolock gibbon inhabits specific pockets of Arunachal Pradesh and Assam in India, southern China, and north-east Myanmar.

- It is listed as Vulnerable in the IUCN Red list.

21. Veera Pasi, recently seen in the news, is associated with:

वीरा पासी, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहीं, किससे संबंधित हैं?

- Revolt of 1857
- Non-Cooperation Movement
- Quit India Movement
- Champaran Satyagraha

Answer: A

Veera Pasi

- On May 20, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi unveiled a statue of **Veera Pasi, a "forgotten hero" who had fought the British during the Revolt of 1857, in Raebareli.**
- — Veera Pasi was a **trusted companion and commander of Rana Beni Madhav Baksh Singh, the ruler of the Shankarpur Estate in modern-day Raebareli during the 19th century.**
- — **A Dalit belonging to the Pasi caste, Pasi was born on November 11, 1835, into an impoverished family in Lodhwari village of Raebareli district.**
- — In the local dialect, a brother living with his sister's family was called "Veerna", which later evolved into the name "Veera".
- — **According to local folklore, when the British captured Singh during the 1857 revolt, Pasi displayed remarkable bravery by rescuing Singh from prison.**
- The British government then announced a reward of Rs 50,000 for the capture or information on Pasi's whereabouts.



Who is Veera Pasi, the 'forgotten hero' of the 1857 Revolt whose statue Rahul Gandhi unveiled in Raebareli



22. "JEEVAN" mobile application, recently seen in news, was launched by:

हाल ही में खबरों में रहा मोबाइल एप्लिकेशन "JEEVAN" किसके द्वारा लॉन्च किया गया था?

- Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- Ministry of Women and Child Development
- Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- Ministry of Rural Development

Answer: C

Launch of JEEVAN App and SHATAYU Geriatric Caregiver Dashboard



- **Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment Launched “JEEVAN”** (Joint Elderly Empowerment & Virtual Assistance Network) Mobile Application for Senior Citizens and “SHATAYU” (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training For Your Utility) Geriatric Caregiver Dashboard.
- The JEEVAN app provides a range of features aimed at addressing the needs and concerns of senior citizens, including information on Government schemes and welfare programmes, emergency assistance and support services, and details of senior citizen homes supported by the Department of Social Justice and Empowerment.
- The platform has been designed with a user-friendly interface, simplified navigation and accessibility features, keeping in view the requirements of elderly users.
- **Another, application “SHATAYU” (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training For Your Utility) a Dashboard, developed to support and strengthen caregiving services for senior citizens** across the country was also launched during the National Workshop on “Creating a Well-Functioning Care Economy.”
- It provides features such as information on the **availability of Geriatric Caregivers** in a particular district and the State for the senior citizens.

23. The Dandewala Field, recently seen in news, is located in:

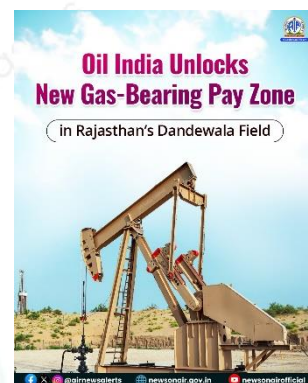
हाल ही में समाचारों में देखा गया 'दंडेवाला फील्ड' कहाँ स्थित है?

- (a) Gujarat
- (b) Rajasthan
- (c) Assam
- (d) Odisha

Answer: (b)

India Finds New Gas Zone in Rajasthan’s Dandewala Field

- Petroleum and Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri informed that **Oil India Limited has successfully unlocked a new gas-bearing pay zone in the Dandewala Field, Rajasthan.**
- The Dandewala field is located in the hydrocarbon-rich Rajasthan basin, which has **emerged as one of India’s key onshore oil and gas producing regions over the past two decades.**
- While the basin is better known for crude oil output, recent exploration efforts have increasingly focused on expanding gas production



24. Consider the following statements regarding “Rangkang” forests:

1. They are untouched forest areas located within jhum cultivation landscapes.
2. These forests are actively cultivated every year.
3. Communities intentionally leave them undisturbed for ecological regeneration.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Anal Naga Tribe

- **For generations, the Anal Naga tribe in Manipur has followed Uju and Rangkang, community-led forest systems that protect trees, water sources and village life.**
- They are an indigenous Tibeto-Burman ethnic group found in Manipur, India, and in Myanmar.
- They are confined mostly in Chandel District, Manipur.
- **They are recognized as a Scheduled Tribe in India.**
- They speak the Anāl language, a Northern Kukish dialect of the Sino-Tibetan family.

Religion:

- The ancient religion of Anal is ‘animist’.
- At present, the overwhelming majority of the population are Christians.

Livelihood:

- They make their living by farming and animal husbandry.
- **For generations, the Anal Naga tribe has protected forests through Uju and Rangkang-community-led systems**

What is Uju?

- It refers to **community-managed reserved forests located near Anal villages.**
- These are **protected collectively**, usually under the supervision of village authorities and elders, who regulate how resources can be used.
- Decisions are made collectively during annual assemblies attended by residents.
- **Discussions range from land disputes and road repairs to forest regulations and jhum cultivation cycles.**
- **Commercial logging is prohibited.**
- **Forest products such as mushrooms, herbs, wild vegetables, flowers, fruits, berries, and medicinal plants may be gathered carefully for household use, but extraction for profit is restricted.**

What is Rangkang?

- It refers to **untouched forest areas located deeper within jhum cultivation landscapes.**
- Unlike Uju, which is actively managed, **Rangkang forests are left largely undisturbed.**
- Over generations, communities have intentionally avoided cultivating these regions, allowing dense ecosystems to regenerate naturally.

25. Ensitrelvir, recently seen in news, is primarily used for the treatment of:

Ensitrelvir, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहा है, मुख्य रूप से किसके उपचार के लिए उपयोग किया जाता है?

- Tuberculosis
- HIV/AIDS
- COVID-19
- Malaria

Answer: (c)

Antiviral Drug Ensitrelvir

- **A recent study published in The New England Journal of Medicine reported that the antiviral drug Ensitrelvir significantly reduced symptomatic COVID-19 infections among exposed household contacts.**
- Ensitrelvir is an **oral antiviral drug** that inhibits the SARS-CoV-2 main protease (3C-like protease/Mpro), an enzyme essential for viral replication.
- **By blocking this protease, the drug prevents the coronavirus from processing viral proteins required for multiplication inside human cells.**



"If approved, ensitrelvir will not replace vaccines. It will not eliminate the need to stay home when sick, to avoid socializing while coughing, or to improve ventilation in workplaces. . . . But it could fill a real gap: a short-course oral medication for people recently exposed to Covid."

NEJM VOICES | PAUL E. SAX, M.D.

Aim:

- To treat mild-to-moderate COVID-19 infections and reduce viral transmission after exposure.
- To provide a safer and longer-lasting oral antiviral option without requiring booster drugs like ritonavir.

Key Features:

- **Protease Inhibitor Mechanism:** Targets the SARS-CoV-2 main protease (Mpro), preventing viral replication.
- **Oral Antiviral Drug:** Can be administered orally, making it suitable for outpatient and household use.
- **Broad Variant Activity:** Showed effectiveness against multiple SARS-CoV-2 variants, including Omicron.

26. Kopra Reservoir is located in which State?

कोपरा जलाशय किस राज्य में स्थित है?

- Odisha
- Jharkhand
- Madhya Pradesh
- Chhattisgarh

Answer: (D)

The Kopra Reservoir

- The Kopra Reservoir has emerged as a national biodiversity model embodying the 2026 International Day for Biological Diversity theme, "Local Action, Global Impact."

- The Kopra Reservoir is a premier ecological wetland ecosystem that serves as Chhattisgarh's inaugural Ramsar Site of International Importance.
- **Location:** Situated in the Bilaspur district of **Chhattisgarh, India**.
- Functions as a vital socio-economic and hydrological anchor for regional communities while acting as a crucial sanctuary for diverse aquatic life and avifauna.
- **Originally constructed as an artificial water storage reservoir to support local agricultural irrigation and fish farming, Kopra gradually transformed over the decades into a thriving, self-sustaining wetland ecosystem.**
- Local communities and village panchayats traditionally co-managed its waters for survival.

27. The Gulmarg Gondola is primarily a:

गुलमर्ग गोंडोला मुख्य रूप से एक:

- High-speed railway system
- Commercial cable car lift system
- Underground metro network
- Mountain highway corridor

Answer: (b)

The Gulmarg Gondola

- **More than 300 tourists, including women and children, were safely rescued** during a massive seven-hour joint operation after a **major technical snag halted the Gulmarg Gondola ropeway in Jammu and Kashmir.**
- The Gulmarg Gondola is a **world-famous, premier commercial cable car lift system** that stands as a core anchor of the region's tourism economy.
- **Location:** Situated in the alpine resort town of Gulmarg within the Baramulla district of Jammu and Kashmir, India.

Key Features:

- **Asia's Highest Aerial Ride:** It holds the distinct geological title of being the longest and highest gondola ride in Asia, as well as the second longest and highest anywhere in the world.
- **Substantial Transit Elevation:** The two-stage ropeway ascends to a maximum altitude of 4,200 meters (13,780 feet) near the snow-covered Apharwat Peak.



7-Hour Rescue Operation Saves 300 Tourists After Gulmarg Ropeway Mishap

A massive multi-agency rescue operation involving the Indian Army, disaster response teams, police personnel, and local authorities safely evacuated more than 300 tourists stranded mid-air after a technical snag hit the famous Gulmarg Gondola ropeway in Jammu and Kashmir.



28. Kautilya is primarily an:

कौटिल्य मुख्य रूप से एक है:

- Missile defence system
- AI-powered command intelligence platform
- Satellite communication network
- Cybersecurity firewall

Answer: (b)

Indian Army Develops AI Platforms Kautilya and Q-FORCE

- The Indian Army developed two Artificial Intelligence-based digital systems, **Kautilya and Q-FORCE, in 2026 for command intelligence and logistics management.**
- Kautilya is an AI-powered command intelligence platform.
 - **It uses AI-enabled dashboards and Natural Language Processing-based interfaces for structured data generation, analytics, and decision support.**
- **Q-FORCE is an integrated digital application for supply chain and sustainment operations.**
 - Q-FORCE was launched around 22–25 May 2026 as an integrated digital application for logistics management.
 - It is designed to streamline inventory handling, supply chain management, and sustainment operations.



29. The ABHA number is:

ABHA नंबर है:

- A. A 10-digit hospital code
- B. A 12-digit insurance number
- C. A 14-digit digital health ID
- D. A biometric identification number

Answer: C.

Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission

- **The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) has achieved a major milestone with over 100 crore health records successfully linked with Ayushman Bharat Health Accounts (ABHA).**
- It was launched to build a comprehensive digital health ecosystem for the country.
- **The mission aims to develop the backbone necessary** to support the integrated digital health infrastructure of the country.
- **The flagship scheme was launched with an outlay of ₹1,600 crore for 5 years from 2021-2022 to 2025-2026.**
- It is implemented by the National Health Authority under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Key Components of Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission

- **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) Number:** It is a 14 digit health ID for hassle-free method of accessing and sharing your health records digitally.
- It is a **comprehensive repository of all healthcare professionals** involved in delivery of healthcare services across both modern and traditional systems of medicine.
- **It is envisioned as an open protocol for various digital health services.** UHI Network will be an open network of End User Applications (EUAs) and participating Health Service Provider (HSP) applications.
- **National Health Claims Exchange (NHCE):** It enables exchange of standardized health claim-related information between payers, providers, beneficiaries, and other relevant entities

**30. The newly unveiled "Information Agents" feature was launched by:**

हाल ही में पेश किया गया "Information Agents" फीचर किसके द्वारा लॉन्च किया गया था?

- (a) Microsoft
- (b) OpenAI
- (c) Google
- (d) Meta

Answer: (c)

Information Agents

- Google unveiled something called information agents, a **feature that will be built into Search to monitor the web on your behalf.**
- **An information agent is a computational software entity (an intelligent agent) that may access one or multiple, distributed, and heterogeneous information sources available, and proactively acquires, mediates, and maintains relevant information on behalf of its users.**
- Information agents are supposed to cope with the difficulties associated with the information overload of the user.

31. India's first hydrogen-powered train will run between:

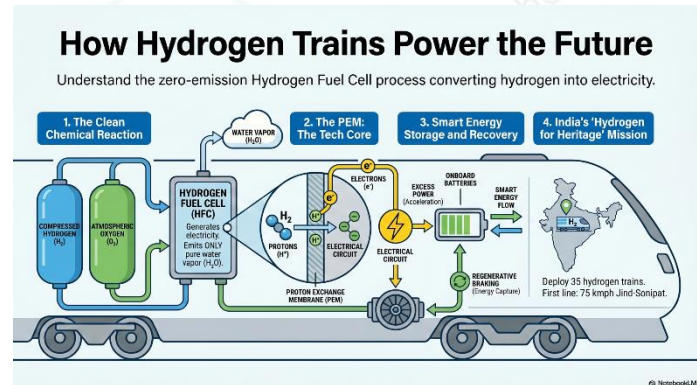
भारत की पहली हाइड्रोजन-संचालित ट्रेन किन स्थानों के बीच चलेगी?

- (a) Delhi and Jaipur
- (b) Jind and Sonapat
- (c) Mumbai and Pune
- (d) Chennai and Bengaluru

Answer: b

India's first hydrogen train: How does hydrogen fuel cell technology work?

- The Railway Board (RB) approved the introduction of the country's first hydrogen-powered trainset. Hydrogen trains – often referred to as 'hydrail' or 'H-trains' provide a viable alternative to diesel locomotives on non-electrified railway routes.
- The country's first hydrogen-powered train will run between Jind and Sonipat in Haryana. It is developed by Chennai-based Integral Coach Factory (ICF). The 10-car hydrogen-powered set will operate at a maximum speed of 75 kmph.
- Decarbonisation of the railways is a significant step towards attaining the net-zero goal by 2070. Indian Railways under "Hydrogen for Heritage" envisages deploying 35 hydrogen-powered trains on heritage and hill routes across the country.
- Hydrogen trains are electric trains with an onboard power source, unlike conventional electric trains that are powered via overhead wires.
- They use HFC (Hydrogen Fuel Cell) technology, which generates energy through the electrochemical reaction of compressed hydrogen with atmospheric oxygen, emitting water vapour as the sole byproduct. This makes the system a zero-emission mechanism at the point of use.



32. UMMID programme, recently seen in news, is primarily related to:

UMMID कार्यक्रम, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहा है, मुख्य रूप से किससे संबंधित है?

- Artificial Intelligence research
- Rare genetic disorders and diseases
- Maternal healthcare services
- Nutrition security programmes

The Union Minister for Science & Technology dedicated the UMMID Programme

- UMMID (Unique Methods of Management of Inherited Disorders) programme is launched for Rare Genetic Disorders/ Diseases.
- It is a national initiative promoting early intervention and affordable healthcare for families affected by rare genetic disorders
- It is aimed at improving the diagnosis and management of inherited and rare genetic disorders.
- The initiative represents India's first comprehensive national effort to address inherited genetic disorders through an integrated approach encompassing diagnosis, counselling, prevention, training and public health awareness.

The programme functions through three major pillars such as:

- NIDAN Kendras for diagnostics and counselling, outreach programmes in aspirational districts, and specialised training centres for capacity building.
- It supports implementation of the National Policy for Rare Diseases (NPRD) 2021 by creating structured care pathways for patients suffering from inherited disorders.
- Nodal Ministry: It is a national initiative led by the Department of Biotechnology, Ministry of Science & Technology to tackle inherited genetic disorders

33. The Daishoin Buddhist Temple complex is located in which country?

दाइशोइन बौद्ध मंदिर परिसर किस देश में स्थित है?

- China
- South Korea
- Thailand
- Japan

Answer: D

Daishoin Temple

- A fire destroyed part of the Daishoin Buddhist temple complex, the Reikado Hall, which housed Japan's 'eternal flame' for 1,200 years
- It is a Buddhist temple of the Shingon School located on Miyajima Island in the Chugoku region of Japan
- It lies at the base of Mount Misen, the tallest mountain on Miyajima
- It was founded by Kobo Daishi in 806 on his return from China following gumonji-ho, a 100-day Buddhist training
- Its vast grounds are covered in multiple unique halls, structures, and statues



About Miyajima Island

- Miyajima, also known as Itsukushima, is a small island located in the Seto Inland Sea off the coast of Japan.
- Hiroshima is the nearest major city.
- It is famous for its "floating" red torii gate that appears to stand on water during high tide.
- Itsukushima Shrine: It is listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

34. The belief system "Iyu-ena" associated with the Idu Mishmi tribe refers to:

इदु मिशमी जनजाति से जुड़ी विश्वास प्रणाली "इयु-एना" का संबंध है:

- A form of shifting cultivation
- A martial dance tradition
- Myths and taboos restricting hunting of animals
- A customary village council system

Answer: C

Idu Mishmi Tribe

- The Idu Mishmi tribal people of Arunachal have a unique cosmology rooted in conservation.
- It is one of the tribal groups who have been living primarily in the Dibang Valley, lower Dibang, and Lohit districts of Arunachal Pradesh.
- They primarily live in Mishmi Hills, bordering Tibet in Arunachal Pradesh.
- They can be distinctively identified by their typical hairstyle, distinctive customs and artistic pattern embedded on their clothes.
- **Occupation:** They are known for their weaving and craftsmanship skills.
- **Language:** Their language, called 'Idu Mishmi', is considered endangered by UNESCO.

Relationship with Nature

- Traditionally animists, the tribe has strong ties with the region's rich flora and fauna.
- **Tigers are especially important to the Idu Mishmis** — according to Idu mythology, they were born to the same mother, and thus, tigers are their "elder brothers".
- **Iyu-ena':** It is a strict belief system of myths and taboos that restrict them from hunting many animals, including a complete prohibition on killing tigers.
- **Festivals:** They celebrate festivals such as Reh and Ke-Meh-Ha.
- They brew local rice beer called Ebu.

35. The Sanchu Border Outpost is located in:

सांचू सीमा चौकी यहाँ स्थित है:

- Punjab
- Rajasthan
- Gujarat
- Jammu & Kashmir

Answer: (b)

Four-Dimensional Grid' Border Security Model

- Union Home Minister proposed a new Four-Dimensional Grid border security framework during his visit to the Sanchu Border Outpost in Rajasthan along the India-Pakistan border.

- The Four-Dimensional Grid is a proposed integrated border security framework designed to create a coordinated, **multi-layered defense mechanism along India's international borders.**
- **It combines the operational strengths of the Border Security Force (BSF), the Army, local administration, cyber surveillance units, and vigilant border residents into a unified security architecture.**

Aim:

- To establish foolproof border security against infiltration, smuggling, drones, and cross-border terrorism.
- To improve coordination between military, civil administration, and local communities for faster threat detection and response.

36. "HIND NAGAR," established by the Custodian Force of India (CFI) was located in:

कस्टोडियन फ़ोर्स ऑफ़ इंडिया (CFI) द्वारा स्थापित "हिंद नगर" स्थित था:

- A. Japan
- B. North Korea
- C. South Korea
- D. Vietnam

Answer: C.

Rajnath Singh, South Korean Minister Inaugurate Indian War Memorial in Seoul

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Republic of Korea's Minister of Patriots and Veterans Affairs Kwon Oh-eul jointly inaugurated the **Indian War Memorial at Imjingak Park in Seoul**
- Commemorating the 75th anniversary of the Korean War and honouring the contribution of Indian troops during the conflict
- **The memorial stands at the site where the CFI had established "HIND NAGAR" in 1954, which housed nearly 22,000 prisoners of war before their peaceful repatriation.**

37. The recently discussed Kalai-II Hydroelectric Project has raised environmental concerns primarily because:

हाल ही में चर्चा में रहे कलाई-॥ जलविद्युत परियोजना ने मुख्य रूप से इन कारणों से पर्यावरणीय चिंताएँ उत्पन्न की हैं:

- (a) It is proposed inside a marine protected area
- (b) It threatens a critical habitat of the White-bellied Heron
- (c) It may submerge a UNESCO World Heritage Site
- (d) It affects the breeding grounds of Olive Ridley turtles

Answer: (b)

Kalai-II hydel project gets forest nod amid concerns

- **The Environment Ministry's Forest Advisory Committee (FAC) has granted in-principle forest clearance to the 1,200 MW Kalai-II hydroelectric project, proposed on the Lohit River, which is one of the key habitats of the critically endangered White-Bellied Heron.**
- The **White-bellied Heron** (*Ardea insignis*), also known as the imperial heron or great white-bellied heron, is a large species of heron in the family Ardeidae. It is **recognized as the 2nd-largest heron in the world.**
- Strictly dependent on free-flowing, fast-flowing eastern Himalayan riverine habitats with low human disturbance.
- **Conservation Status:** Critically Endangered species as per the IUCN Red List.

What is the Kalai-II Hydropower Project?

- It is a **proposed 1,200 MW run-of-river hydroelectric project with pondage (small storage capacity) on the Lohit River**, a major tributary of the Brahmaputra, located in Anjaw district, **Arunachal Pradesh.**
 - It is being developed by Tehri Hydro Development Corporation India Limited.

**38. "Vayu Astra-1" is primarily a:**

"वायु अस्त्र-१" मुख्य रूप से एक:

- A. Loitering munition system
- B. Surface-to-air missile

- C. Ballistic missile defence system
D. Anti-submarine drone

Answer: A

Indigenous Vayu Astra-1 completes high-altitude trials in Uttarakhand, Pokhran

- Pune-based defence technology firm Nibe Limited has successfully completed no-cost, no-commitment demonstrations of its indigenous loitering munition system 'Vayu Astra-1' during trials conducted at Pokhran in Rajasthan, and Joshimath (Malari) in Uttarakhand for the Indian Army.
- The company conducted the first demonstration of the anti-personnel variant of the Vayu Astra-1 at the Pokhran Range ,
- Equipped with a 10-kg warhead, the loitering munition successfully struck its target at a range of 100 km in a single attempt, achieving a Circular Error Probable (CEP) of less than one metre



39. The Abraham Accords are primarily related to normalization of relations between:

अब्राहम समझौते मुख्य रूप से इनके बीच संबंधों के सामान्यीकरण से संबंधित हैं:

- (a) Israel and several Arab nations
(b) India and Pakistan
(c) Iran and Saudi Arabia
(d) Russia and Ukraine

Answer: (a)

What is Abraham Accords and who signed it? Full list of countries.

- U.S. President Donald Trump called on Muslim-majority nations in West Asia and beyond to establish normalised relations with Israel in the context of the developing peace agreement with Iran .
- It also listed countries whose leaders he spoke with about efforts to end the war with Iran, which included the signing of the Abraham Accords.

What is Abraham Accords?

- The Abraham Accords are a set of agreements brokered by Mr. Trump in 2020, which were widely recognised as a significant achievement in foreign policy.
- These accords marked a pivotal shift in the relationships between Israel and several Arab nations. With robust bipartisan support from the United States, four countries began diplomatic efforts to formalise ties with Israel between August and December 2020.
- These ties were also driven by a common apprehension regarding Iran's regional power and nuclear initiatives, as well as to strengthen relations with the United States.

How many countries signed the Abraham Accords?

- United States
- United Arab Emirates (UAE).
- Bahrain
- Israel
- Morocco
- Kosovo and Sudan

40. The Bioethanol Agricultural Project (Uttar Pradesh) involved which organisation paying an upfront benefit-sharing fee to access local agricultural residues in Aligarh for bioethanol research under the ABS framework?

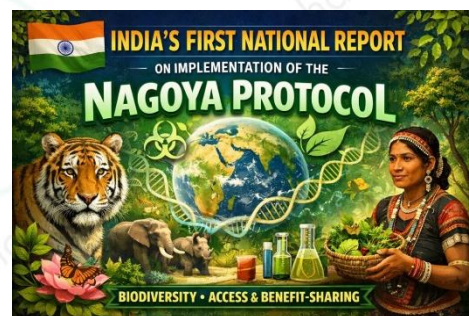
- (a) Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC)
(b) National Thermal Power Corporation (NTPC)
(c) Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL)
(d) Gas Authority of India Limited (GAIL)

Answer: (C)



India Leads Global IRCC Issuance Under Nagoya Protocol

- The Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) published insights from India's First National Report on the Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit Sharing (ABS).
- **The Nagoya Protocol is a landmark supplementary international treaty to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) that was adopted globally in 1992.**
- Officially titled the **Nagoya Protocol on Access to Genetic Resources and the Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits Arising from their Utilization**, it creates a transparent, legally binding framework to ensure that physical biological materials or Digital Sequence Information (DSI) are accessed and used fairly.

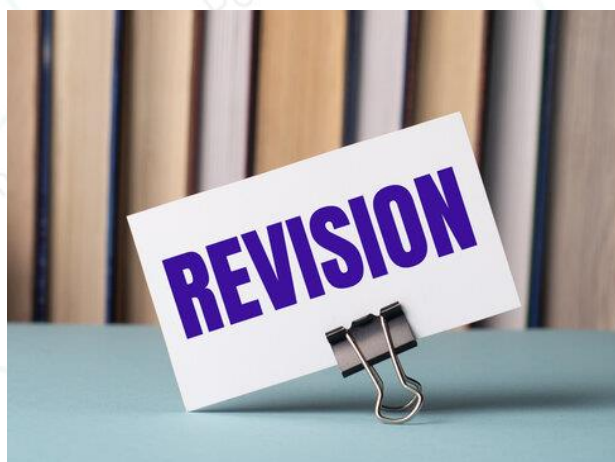


Key Findings of India's First National Report:

- **Massive Scale of Legal Approvals:** Between November 1, 2017, and December 31, 2025, India granted a total of 12,830 approvals under the ABS framework.
- **India has emerged as a clear global leader in biodiversity traceability**, publishing 3,556 Internationally Recognized Certificates of Compliance (IRCCs) via the global clearing-house. This single-handedly accounts for 60.24% of all certificates issued worldwide.
- The report highlights India's vast community-based governance network. This includes the NBA at the apex, SBBs in all states, and more than 2,76,653 local Biodiversity Management Committees (BMCs) set up by elected local bodies to manage regional resources.

Successful Domestic Case Studies Highlighted:

- **The Dengue Treatment Resource (Madhya Pradesh):** Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd. paid an upfront fee of ₹4,50,000 to access the medicinal plant *Cocculus hirsutus* from the forests of Chhindwara.
- **The Bioethanol Agricultural Project (Uttar Pradesh):** Indian Oil Corporation Limited paid an upfront benefit-sharing fee of ₹18,60,000 to access local agricultural residues in Aligarh for bioethanol research.



Important Headlines

- Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan releasing a book named *The Library Man of India: The Story of P.N. Panicker* at Uprashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi by P. P. Sathyan
- 'Shri Kshetra Dharmasthala: The Heart of Dharma', a book brought out by THG Publishing Private Limited, was released in Dharmasthala, Karnataka.
- A book commemorating India's first-ever Olympic gold by hockey historian K. Arumugam was released by Indian Olympic Association president P.T. Usha.
- Siddaramaiah formally resigned as the Chief Minister of Karnataka

- Additional Director General of Police (ADGP) A. Amalraj took charge as the Greater Chennai City Police Commissioner.
- Manipur Police chief Rajiv Singh has been appointed as Secretary (Security) in the Cabinet Secretariat.
- Senior Congress leader and former Minister Thiruvanchoor Radhakrishnan was elected as Speaker of the 16th Kerala Legislative Assembly
- The Karnataka government decided to appoint retired judge P.N. Desai as chairperson of the Karnataka State Human Rights Commission.
- In the United States, Kevin Warsh has taken the oath of office as Chairman of the US Federal Reserve Board of Governors, succeeding Jerome Powell, who had held the position since 2018.
- Former IAS officer Elias George has been appointed chairperson of the board of directors of Federal Bank Ltd.
- India's Davis Cup captain Rohit Rajpal has been appointed as the country's Chef de Mission for the upcoming Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, scheduled to be held from July 23 to August 2.
- Neelam Meena, a 1998-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer, was appointed the first woman chief electoral officer (CEO) of West Bengal.
- Major Abhilasha Barak to receive 2025 UN military gender advocate award
- Kannan C.S. Warriar, Director of Kerala Forest Research Institute, has been conferred the Editor of Distinction Award 2026 by Springer Nature, which stands as one of the world's prestigious scientific, technical, and medical publishers.
- President Droupadi Murmu conferred the prestigious President's Police Colour to the Sikkim Police.
- Renowned Urdu poet Bashir Badr passed away in Bhopal
- Toshifumi Suzuki, the founder of Seven-Eleven Japan and widely regarded as the father of Japan's convenience store industry, died. He was 93
- Sonny Rollins, the legendary "Saxophone Colossus" and one of the last towering giants of the golden bebop era, has died at the age of 95
- Veteran actor Ramakant Dayama, best known for appearing in films like Chak De India, Crew, Paa, among others, died
- Dr. Patnam Siva Rama Krishna Rao, veteran physician, teacher and author of the widely respected medical textbook 'Differential Diagnoses and Medical Therapeutics', passed away
- On May 16, Abhijeet Dipke launched the Cockroach Janta Party, a satirical digital outfit, following a controversy over Chief Justice of India Surya Kant's "parasites" and "cockroaches" remark
- The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports will organise the 75th Mega Edition of Fit India Sundays on Cycle to celebrate Commonwealth Games Day nationwide.
- The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) announced major achievements under the nationwide 'Khet Bachao Abhiyan', aimed at promoting balanced fertilizer use and sustainable farming practices.
- A three-day Training of Trainers (ToT) programme on "Freedom from Violence: Capacity Building of Elected Women Representatives on Legal Provisions for the Safety and Security of Women" was organised by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj from 25th to 27th May 2026 in New Delhi.

- Supreme Court Recognises Trauma Care Under Article 21
- The Supreme Court recently revisited the issue of bail under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) while granting interim bail to accused in the 2020 Delhi riots case.
- Recently, the reconstituted Public Accounts Committee (PAC) convened and took up certain subjects for examination.
- The Centre for HR Information Systems, Research and Analytics in Governance (CHIRAG), a Centre of Excellence focused on human resource management training, research, and digital transformation in Indian Railways.
- The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) introduced a series of user-friendly reforms under the PM-WANI (Prime Minister's Wi-Fi Access Network Interface) framework.
- Under the chairmanship of Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan, the Department of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare, Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare is organizing the National Conference on Agriculture for Kharif Campaign 2026 on 28th–29th May 2026 at the NASC Complex, Pusa, New Delhi.
- A joint team of the Army, Jammu and Kashmir Police and the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) had launched the operation 'Sheruwali'
- India has launched two major Chenab-linked projects worth nearly Rs 2,600 crore weeks after putting the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) framework with Pakistan in abeyance,
- Delhi Government announced the launch of the Talent Hunt Scheme- Hauslon ki Udaan 2026-27.
- Odisha's Handlooms, Textiles and Handicrafts department has launched a revival plan for the original Bomkai weaving tradition in Ganjam district, titled Revival of Languishing Products (Cotton Bomkai Saree) .
- A major fire broke out at the Machkund Hydroelectric Project located on the Odisha-Andhra Pradesh border recently.
- The main celebration of the International Day of Yoga (IDY) 2026 will be held in Kolkata, West Bengal on 21 June, Theme for this year's observance is "Yoga for Healthy Ageing",
- The West Bengal Directorate of Madrasa Education has made the singing of "Vande Mataram" mandatory during assembly prayers before classes in all government, aided and recognised madrasas across the State with immediate effect.
- Union Minister joined the 150-year celebrations of the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS) in Kolkata.
- Sikkim has been declared a fully literate state under the ULLAS (Understanding of Lifelong Learning for All in Society) initiative.
- Sikkim has officially become a full-fledged member of the Brahmaputra Board, along with West Bengal.
- The Assam Assembly passed the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill even as the Opposition demanded that it be sent to a select committee. Assam became the third State, after Uttarakhand and Gujarat, to pass a Uniform Civil Code Bill.
- The Central University of Rajasthan (CUoR) has launched a new research promotion scheme for scholars to empower them financially and encourage them to pursue quality research without financial stress.

- Geologists have discovered a rare, microscopic sunflower-shaped mineral, pyrite, commonly known as fool's gold, within the lignite coal reserves of Gujarat, India.
- Deployment of high-capacity harvester machines at Ambazari Lake has finally given a major push to the long-pending battle against the massive spread of water hyacinth. located near the southwest border of Nagpur in Maharashtra
- Swachha Andhra Corporation Chairman K. Pattabhi Ram launched "Operation Clean Sweep," a month-long campaign aimed at transforming cities and towns into garbage-free zones, in Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh.
- The city of Vijayawada is fully geared up to host the prestigious Andhra Pradesh MSME Growth Summit 2026 at the newly constructed Dr Ambedkar Kala Vedika Convention Centre, which will be formally inaugurated by Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu ahead of the summit.
- Hutti Gold Mines, the only functional gold mine in the country, earned a whopping ₹633.34 crores more in 2025-26, thanks to the skyrocketing price of gold in the world market.
- The plight of the Koraga tribe has spotlighted deep housing inequality globally, with the UN-Habitat World Cities Report 2026 noting that entrenched caste barriers and policy gaps continue to deny many communities access to secure housing.
- KERALA HOME Minister Ramesh Chennithala announced a special drive against drug menace — 'Operation Toofan, the narco hunt' to uproot the drug mafia
- India's First Private Medical Museum Opens in Thiruvananthapuram, It is Kerala's first private medical museum
- Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala announced the launch of 'Project Zero', an anti-corruption initiative by the Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) that aims at making Kerala a corruption-free State.
- Madurai, Tamil Nadu: An intensive preventive policing and crime deterrence drive, christened Operation SHIELDNET, was rolled out across all 10 districts and Tirunelveli City in the South Zone .
- The Ukrainian President said recently that Russia used the powerful hypersonic Oreshnik ballistic missile during a mass drone and missile attack on Kyiv.
- Recently, India successfully tested the short-range ballistic missile Agni-1 from the Integrated Test Range in Balasore, Odisha. It is a single-stage, solid-fuel missile.
- Suryakiran Aerobatic Team (SKAT) of the Indian Air Force will celebrate its 30th anniversary on May 26 in Bidar.
- Global networking brand TP-Link announced the start of local manufacturing for its Wi-Fi 7 in India , Wi-Fi 7 is the newest generation of wireless communication, formally designated as IEEE 802.11 be Extremely High Throughput (EHT).
- Chandrayaan-2 detects possible presence of subsurface ice near south pole of moon, A detailed investigation of sub-surface ice in the lunar South Polar Region using observations from the Chandrayaan-2 Dual Frequency Synthetic Aperture Radar (DFSAR) have been carried out by the scientists from Physical Research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad.
- UMMID (Unique Methods of Management of Inherited Disorders) programme is launched for Rare Genetic Disorders/ Diseases.

- Researchers at the International Advanced Research Centre for Powder Metallurgy and New Materials (ARCI) announced the development of a low-cost, high-performance spinel nanocomposite Phase Change Material (PCM), an advanced clean technology designed to stock thermal energy by heating or cooling a storage medium.
- The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare officially brought the neurological drug Pregabalin under the stricter purview of Schedule H1 of the Drugs Rules, 1945.
- New observations from the James Webb Space Telescope suggest that Nereid may not have originated from the Kuiper Belt, as its crystalline water ice and unique spectral signature differ from known Kuiper Belt objects.
- Around 70 cattle have died in Odisha's Kendrapada district recently, with the chief district veterinary officer attributing most of the deaths to amphistomes, or rumen flukes disease, locally known as 'Kurmi'.
- China launched the Shenzhou-23 mission with a three-member crew aboard a Long March 2-F rocket from the Jiuquan launch centre in north-western China.
- The Indian Council of Medical Research launched India's largest biomedical innovation and technology transfer platform, "Medical Innovations Patent Mitra: Innovators-to-Industry (I2I) Connect," in New Delhi to bridge the gap between scientific research and industry commercialization.
- Scientists from the Jawaharlal Nehru Tropical Botanic Garden and Research Institute have discovered a new evergreen tree species named *Humboldtia nairiana* in the riparian forests of the Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuary.
- A new species of toad recorded in Meghalaya's East Khasi Hills district has been named after Dhara, the traditional Khasi women's attire.
- Recently, Charles Darwin Foundation scientists have discovered a tiny blue octopus species called *Microeledone galapagensis*.
- Scientists announced the discovery of a new amphibian species, *Nyctibatrachus kali* (commonly called the Kali night frog), in the central Western Ghats of Karnataka.
- Saudi Arabia joins International Big Cat Alliance as 26th member nation
- Due to heatwave conditions in Delhi, Sanjay Lake in East Delhi's Trilokpuri turned into a fish graveyard.
- A group of researchers at Catholicate College has discovered a new species of green algae named *Interfilum shuklaili* from the Western Ghats in Kerala.
- Chandu Budhera wetland(Haryana) recently emerged as a migratory stopover for the rare red-necked phalarope.
- Forest officials recently found the rare Himalayan Tricarinate Hill Turtle in the Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve forests of Chhattisgarh, marking an unusual sighting of the Himalayan species in central India.
- India ranks second in Asia Pacific (APAC) markets with 1.6 GW operational capacity, establishing itself as a significant growth engine for digital infrastructure in the region.
- The Sample Registration System is a large-scale demographic sample survey that is being conducted in a random sample of villages and urban blocks.

- According to AQL.in, the global top-100 hottest cities list at 2:50 pm IST were overwhelmingly dominated by Indian cities, with Balangir in Odisha emerging as the hottest location at 48°C.
- The 11th Review Conference of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) at the UN Headquarters in New York collapsed without reaching a consensus on a final declaration.
- US Secretary of State Marco Rubio addressed concerns regarding rising anti-India rhetoric in the US, emphasizing President Donald Trump's affection for India and Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- On a special initiative of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, sacred relics from the UNESCO World Heritage Site Sanchi Stupa are being sent to Mongolia.
- The United Nations has added Israeli entities to a blacklist of countries that commit sexual violence in conflict zones - a list which includes Hamas and other terror organizations.
- On the sidelines of the 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi, the member nations unveiled the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative Framework alongside a separate bilateral India-US mineral pact.
- India officially commenced its tourism agenda under its BRICS 2026 Chairship by hosting the inaugural Tourism Working Group (TWG) meeting via virtual mode.
- Recently, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) has launched a \$10 billion fund facility to support member countries affected by ongoing Middle East conflict.
- Vagmi V.S., an industrial design student from Anant National University, represented India as one of five national envoys at the 2026 UN Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) Youth Forum.
- Vagmi V.S., an industrial design student from Anant National University, represented India as one of five national envoys at the 2026 UN Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) Youth Forum.
- The Seventy-ninth World Health Assembly is being held in Geneva, Switzerland, on 18–23 May 2026.
- India recently gifted a special type of sandalwood to the Nepal government to be used at the Pashupatinath temple on Kathmandu's outskirts.
- A civilian has died and around 36 people have been injured following a fire and 2 powerful explosions at a shipyard on Staten Island in New York City. It is an island located in New York City, United States.
- A submarine volcanic eruption in the Bismarck Sea, north of Papua New Guinea has drawn attention to the poor mapping of the deep ocean floor on Earth.
- The World Health Assembly (WHA) recently passed the first-ever resolution on strokes, urging member states to recognise the medical condition as a public health priority.
- Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya launches championship film of 1st World Yogasana Championship 2026
- Football - Lens lift French Cup 2026.
- Manchester United playmaker Bruno Fernandes has claimed the 2025/26 Premier League Player of the Season award.
- Petr Bar Biryukov secured his maiden ATP Challenger singles title, by defeating Belarusian Ilya Ivashka in the final of the SM Krishna Memorial Open 2026.
- Andrea Kimi Antonelli won the 2026 Canadian Grand Prix
- On the second day of the 2026 Athletics Federation Cup, Gurindervir Singh clinched the gold medal in the men's 100m event in Ranchi with a new national record timing of 10.09 seconds.

- Rupamoni Gorh has become the first woman from Assam to successfully summit Mount Everest.
- The Fire and Fury Corps of the Indian Army successfully organised the week-long Batalik Volleyball Championship in the border region of Ladakh, which concluded on May 23, 2026.
- India created history at the International Association of Ultrarunners 24-Hour Asia and Oceania Championships held in Japan. India won a total of five medals - two Gold, one Silver, and two Bronze medals.
- For the first time ever, Team India will be representing the country at the World Apnea Pool Championship in Budapest starting June 2, 2026.
- Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman launched three major digital portals and cluster-based initiatives during the 37th-anniversary celebrations of the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) in Mumbai.
- The Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) has introduced two new plans New Jeevan Sathi-Single Premium and New Jeevan Sathi-Limited Premium.

QUESTION OF THE DAY

Who won the double gold in the Rapid and Blitz events at the Commonwealth Chess Championship in Sri Lanka?

श्रीलंका में आयोजित राष्ट्रमंडल शतरंज चैंपियनशिप में रैपिड और ब्लिट्ज़ स्पर्धाओं में दोहरा स्वर्ण पदक किसने जीता?

- (a) Srihari
- (b) Mitrabha
- (c) Rohith Krishna
- (d) Iniyan Panneerselvam